heightened efficiency and convenience, and limitless entertainment available at the click of a few buttons from the comfort of our home or office, is perhaps that many of us are less likely to actually go out and about. Chance in-person interactions, which oftentimes led to intimacy in the pre-internet world, are less likely to occur now. You're never going to meet a sexy stranger at the movie theatre if no one goes to movie theatres. You're not going to chat with someone at the bar as you wait for your table for one at a restaurant if you're Swiggying that dinner home instead.

This has been a globally reported trend for several years now. The National Survey of Sexual Health and Behaviour in the US and the National Survey of Sexual Attitudes and Lifestyles in the UK as well as similar surveys in several other countries have found that, over the past three decades, people across geographies reported having less and less sex. While of course there is no "right" or "wrong" level of frequency of sexual activity, that people are having sex less frequently today than they were 30 years ago may seem surprising to many.

There are a few more aspects to consider. With young people more open to delaying marriage than in the past, more of us are less likely to be living with a sexual partner by a certain age—say, the early 20s—than before. As for the 'hook-up culture' and the supposed ease of access to casual sex provided by online dating apps, it's worth keeping in mind that dating apps make it easier for certain people to access sexual intimacy than others. Given the visual basis of the 'swipe' system—swipe right if you like what you see—people who fall within society's traditional definitions of attractiveness (good looks, high income) get the majority of the swipes. The rest often get few or no matches. Additionally, in India, premarital sex remains taboo. Even in 2023, over 52 per cent of the INDIA TODAY sex survey respondents in the 26-35 years age group said 'virginity' was 'important' to them.

Notably, while porn consumption is another key facet of the internet era—leading many to believe that people know more about sex and the body today than they did before—it's worth remembering that learning about sex from mainstream internet porn is like learning how to drive by watching *Fast & Furious*. Not the greatest reference point. In fact, for many, it's also another reason to stay home. How could your dating pool compete with the abundance, variety and intensity of what's on offer on the internet? And yet, consider the fact that over half of the INDIA TODAY survey's respondents said they had no idea what the G-Spot is (by the way, it's simply an erogenous zone within the vaginal canal due to the proximity to the internal parts of the clitoris and the urethra, not a separate physical structure or a 'magic button'). Therefore, mainstream porn is not a stand-in for comprehensive sex education.



WE'RE MORE LIKELY TO BE 'TOO BUSY' ON MOST DAYS TO HAVE SEX

Speaking from personal experience, technology has certainly impacted how much sex I have. I was definitely having more sex in 2013 than I am in 2023. I had less work, no social media, no Netflix, no vibrator and far less experience dating. Today, with constant deadlines that have me working past midnight on most days, overwhelming amounts of great OTT shows to choose from when in need of entertainment, the knowledge that hookups are often disappointing and an enviable sex toy collection, the idea of having to actually deal with a person or disrupt my vaginal pH seems much less exciting than it did once. Even for people who live with their partner, so often, both parties get into bed glued to their respective smartphones, not each other.

Perhaps the key to having more and more satisfying sex is to ultimately put our phones away. ■

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